Anthropology 151

Exam 2

Unit 2 of this course focuses on the dispersal of our species across the globe. We first reviewed some of the methods applied to determine the timing and environmental contexts of these dispersals and then investigate specific migratory routes across Eurasia and into Polynesia and the Americas. The exam topics listed below cover the primary themes discussed throughout the unit. Remember when building your exam to develop a thesis statement regarding some aspect of the topic you choose and then use evidence from the readings (assigned reading and readings you find for references) to support that thesis.

Quick note on structure and ai

I don't really have much of an ai policy. I understand that it is a tool that is more and more difficult to shy away from. I really don't mind if this is used while you are building your presentations. That being said, the work you submit still needs to be your own. Presentations that are built with ai tend to have strange formats that do not work well to illustrate the topics. The images are often nonspecific and occasionally misleading (or simply false). AI also has a habit of creating false citations and/or misrepresenting the research from real citations. You would do best to double check the information you use, write out your thoughts on the topic, and find images from the research articles or educational material that you are citing. The highest grades on these exams come from students who have complete slide notes that are cited and discussed in the student's own words. You are not expected to illustrate mastery in a subject, just a familiarity with it and the materials that you read. Have an opinion. If something is confusing to you, mention that. I really am just hoping that you learn how to construct an argument, present evidence, and research a topic.

Exam 2 Topic List

1) Behavior, Technology, and Culture during the last glacial period.
    a. The success of our species during the last glacial period (~115-11.4 ka) was driven by behavioral flexibility and innovation. Review the emergent technology and new behaviors that helped along the way. *What new Behaviors, Technology, and Cultural Practices helped H. sapiens navigate the Late Pleistocene environment of Eurasia?*

2) Impacts of climate and shifting environments on human migrations outside of Africa
    a. The success of human migrations during the Pleistocene have as much to do with the presence of favorable conditions as they do with behavioral adaptations. Explain how shifting habitats, sea levels, glacial ice, and resources created corridors for early human migrations as we ventured outside of Africa (throughout Europe, Asia, Australia, and/or North America). *What were the primary environmental factors that facilitated one or more of these migrations?*
3) Out of Africa, Over and Over Again
    a. Hominins had ventured out from the African continent multiple times throughout the Paleolithic. *H. sapiens*, in particular, is known to have multiple "pulses" of migration into Eurasia, with the last primary pulse occurring between approximately 59-47 ka. Explain these different waves of migration with a primary emphasis on the last primary pulse. *What were the influences, routes, and results of this migration (include genetic and archaeological evidence*)?
4) Major dispersals across Eurasia.
    a. From Western Asia, populations of *H. sapiens* eventually ventured out in all directions across Eurasia, ultimately occupying nearly every corner of the world. Pick a direction and discuss a migratory route (either into Western Europe, East Asia, Southeast Asia/Australia, North America/South America. *What conditions led to/allowed this migration? What were the routes? Why did populations follow those corridors? What is the timeline?*
5) Polynesian Origins and the Lapita Cultural Complex
    a. Polynesian populations can trace their ancestry to East Asian migrants which expanded from Taiwan and Southern China, throughout Island SE Asia, and into Oceania. Discuss the different forms of evidence that illustrate this ancestral population (linguistic, archaeological, botanical, genetic, and/or ethnographic) and follow the origins and migrations of the Lapita people into Western Polynesia.
6) Peopling of the Americas
    a. Like Polynesia, the ancestors of the original migrants into the Americas can be traced to East (and Northeast) Asia. While this ancestry is well-accepted, there are different hypotheses regarding how these migrants made it into the heart of these continental masses. Explain/discuss the original migrations from Eurasia into the Americas. *What are the competing hypotheses regarding entry into North America? What, in your opinion, is best supported by the evidence?*